In that sense, those who think the BJP is simply the political arm of the Sangh are wrong. It is a far more complicated relationship than that. In 2003, RSS Chief K.S. Sudarshan was asked precisely this question. His response was clear: 'There is no political wing as such. The Sangh prepares individuals who are sent to different fields according to their abilities but their main task is to spread the Hindutva ideology. The only relationship we have is that we are swayamsevaks. At times we get together to discuss how to reach our goals. But we don't accept that BJP is a wing of the RSS or that RSS is a volunteer core of the BJP.'[70]

Where the Sangh does have a major influence is in the realm of ideas, and through that on policy. The RSS saw Modi's twin electoral victories in 2014 and 2019 as the triumph of Hindu nationalist ideas. After the 2014 win, in a signed editorial, *Organiser*'s editor argued that the 'most fundamental shift' it heralded was a 'departure from pseudo-secular divisive politics'.[71] In 2019, he argued even more forcefully that the result showed the 'so-called "Khan-Market consensus" based on the elitist approach is irrelevant for the masses'. For the RSS, the 'most important faultline' in the 2019 election was whether what it saw as an 'elitist "Idea of India", that would decide what is good or bad for Bharat is acceptable or not.' The RSS seems to have interpreted Modi's second national election victory as the triumph of a 'new narrative for new Bharat'[72] that, in its view, was clearly based on a return to Hindu-ness and a Hindu-focused moral order.